

The CMS is expected to have a massive scope, in fact as per C-DOT's ambitions, once fully setup and in its second year of operation, the system will be able to track any mobile user in the country up to 95% accuracy. Apart from just being able to track your geographical location within our borders, the CMS is

BlackBerry and the Indian government following which BlackBerry did comply with directives to let the government monitor all of its users' encrypted data. These aren't isolated incidents but rather signify how important online surveillance is for the intelligence gathering community both within our borders and

that while globally about 79% of Internet users were concerned about online privacy, that number jumped to 94% when it came to Indian citizens.

The Road Ahead

So, if you haven't already put a gun to your head, this is where you stand. Everything that you do online or on your cellphone can be tracked, intercepted, monitored and collated by not only your own government but also foreign ones. Thanks to the paranoia that the words 'terrorism' and 'national security' can engender, you, in effect, have minimal or altogether no right to expect privacy if you happen to use the Internet or a cellphone.

The only possible way to fight back to regain your right to privacy would be spread the word about what is going on and hope that soon this fight will gain enough traction to garner the attention of the lawmakers. Only when more and more of Internet users start caring deeply about their privacy and what rights they

also expected to be able to record phone calls, intercept and analyze emails and messages and monitor VoIP communication and will be integrated into the system that's already monitoring Internet traffic. The CMS will do this using a direct link to all telecom operators in the country through which the data required will be requested and received.

The scary thing is (yup, we realise we've been saying this a lot in this story) that the CMS is completely devoid of any judicial oversight. The government has refused to clarify the process that will be involved to initiate surveillance against an individual and whether doing so will even require a warrant. There has also been no insight into how long a person will be tracked and what will be done with the intercepted data once it's of no use. All we do know is that the CMS will only be under the purview of the Home Ministry and boy, we sure do know that all politicians and bureaucrats in our country can be trusted completely, don't we?

All of these numbers only stand to prove that the government is very, very interested in what you're doing online or on your cellphone. You will remember Kapil Sibal railing against social networks and how there was a need to monitor them for inflammatory content. You will also remember that earlier this year, a man from Agra was arrested under Section 66 (A) of the IT Act for posting images of Mulayam Singh Yadav and Kapil Sibal on Facebook, images that were deemed to be "communal and inflammatory." Further back, last year also saw the to and fro between

overseas and how easy we've made it for them to continue doing so.

Despite this growing trend according to a study conducted by Professor Kumaraguru and Niharika Sachdeva for IIT-Delhi, 75% of Internet users in India are in the dark with respect to online privacy. The study that covered more than

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C-DOT is the organization responsible for implementing the CMS in India.

10,000 Internet users in India showed that a large majority of them did not read the privacy documents that websites and online services provide and had no idea of their privacy rights and how they could be infringed. However, the hope lies in the fact that Indian Internet users do seem to care more than others about online privacy. Research conducted by Big Brother Watch, a UK based privacy group, showed

have, will this fight gather momentum. As we mentioned at the very beginning, our objective with this story was not to try and satiate your worries with the help of stop-gap solutions or moralize about what's right or wrong, but rather help you understand the context and the state of affairs when it comes to privacy online and how your rights are being infringed upon. We hope we've been able to do that. **4**